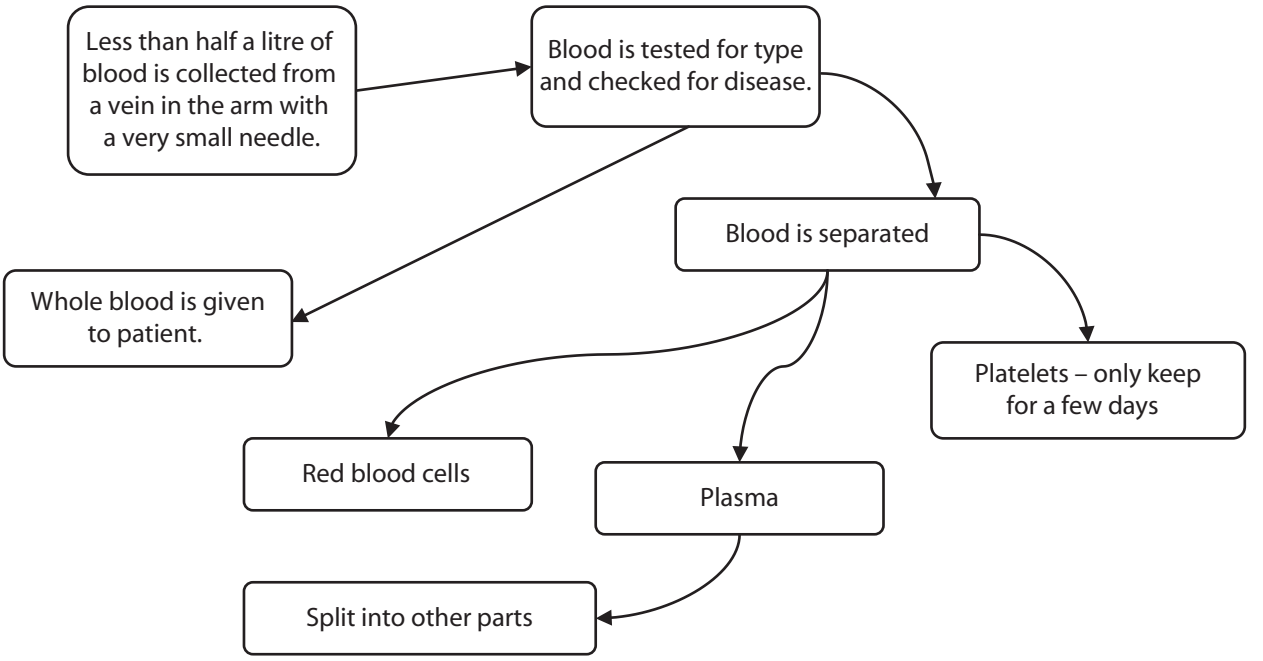
Donating blood

The Australian Red Cross Blood Service collects and distributes blood and blood components. One in three people will need blood at some point in their lives, but only one in thirty people donate it.

What happens to donated blood?



☞ **1** Fill in the missing words and choose the correct word from each pair to complete the passage below.

After the blood [colour/type] is checked, donated blood can be given whole to a patient. However, often the blood is separated into its parts – p_____, p_____ and r___ b_____ c_____. Doctors use the part that will be most effective and [wasteful/efficient] in helping the patient. **Whole blood** is not used if only [platelets/aspirin] are needed, for example. **Red blood cells** are used for anaemia and for high blood [gain/loss] in surgery. **Platelets** help clot wounds, but are often destroyed by chemotherapy. They are transfused into [cancer/flu] patients or used in high blood loss surgery. Platelets only keep for a [hundred/few] days. **Plasma** can be used after injury causing [severe/small] blood loss, and can be split into many parts for the best use, such as with or without different clotting factors.

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